

The ICT Lounge

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Year 7

Year 8

IGCSE

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Section 7.8: Stage 6 - Evaluation

The **final stage** of the system's life cycle is to **evaluate** it's **impact** and **effectiveness**.

Evaluation takes place after the system has been running and in use for a while.

Key Concepts of this section:

- # Understand what is meant by **System Evaluation** .
- # Know **why** it is important to evaluate a system.
- # Be able to **describe** the **tasks involved** when carrying out an evaluation.

Stage 6 - Evaluation

Why is it important to evaluate a system?

- # Systems are **evaluated** in order to determine if:
 - The system is doing the job it was designed to do
 - The system is working well with minimum errors
 - Staff can use the system properly.



Key Words:

Evaluate, Effective, User-Friendly, Functionality.

Examples:

What does an evaluation look for?

- # A **good** and **effective** evaluation of a system will ask the following questions:

Is the system
effective?



- Does the system **work fast**?
- Does the system **run smoothly**?
- Does the system **save** the company **time** and **money**?
- Does the system **reduce paper-waste**?

Is the system easy to use?

- Does the system have a **user-friendly** interface?
- Can everyone **use** the system **easily**?
- Can the system be used with **minimal training**?

Is the system appropriate?

- Does the system perform the **job** it was **designed for**?
- Are the **clients happy** with the system?
- Is there anything the system **can't do** that it **should**?

How is an evaluation carried out?

- # The **answers** to the above questions would be determined by carrying out a **detailed evaluation**.
- # The system's analyst would evaluate the system by completing a **series of tasks**. These tasks include:

Comparing the system against the initial requirements

If you remember back to [stage 1](#), the analyst asked **questions** and **observed staff** in order to figure out exactly **what** the client required the new system to do.

This was called a **requirements specification**.

The analyst will **compare** the **completed system** to each of the **original requirements**.

If each one of the requirements has been met, the new system can be considered a **success**.

Evaluating user's experiences

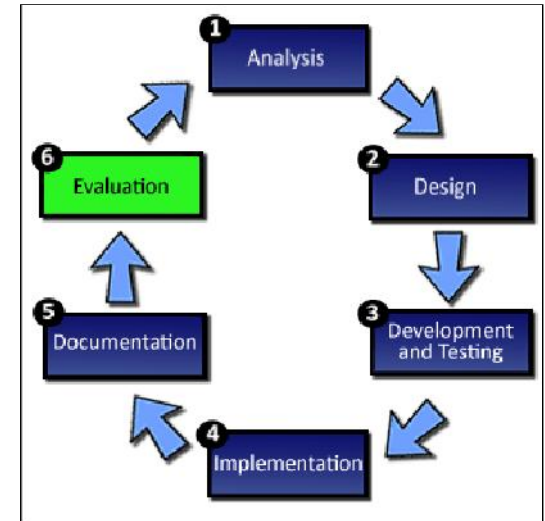
Users of the system will be asked their **views** about the **performance**.

- Do they find the system **easy to use**?
- Does the system **help** them **do their job**?
- Have they experienced any **errors** or **glitches**?

People who use a system on a daily basis can sometimes find problems that testing may **miss**.

Identifying

After evaluating the system, the analyst will make a **list** of



Documentation takes place during the sixth stage of the systems lifecycle.



Effective systems run fast.

limitations of the new systemsystem **limitations**.

These limitations will include anything on the **requirements specification** that the system **cannot do**.

Identifying system improvements

Based on the list of system limitations, the analyst will **recommend improvements** that need to be made to system.

Final improvements

After evaluation has been carried out and the the system's success has been determined, it could be necessary to carry out some **changes/improvements**.

These could include:

Error correction

Any **limitations** and **errors** identified during evaluation will be **fixed** and **tested**.

Add functionality

Users of the system may ask for **extra functions** to be added in order to **improve performance**.

For example: a company may expand into a **different country** and could required **language translation** features added to their system.

Performance improvement

Hardware or software may need to be upgraded:

- **Hardware** - larger hard disk drives, faster servers
- **Software** - system code changed to remove bugs etc.



Effective systems should reduce waste.



The system will be evaluated and compared against the requirements specification list.

What happens next?

After evaluation and improvements have been carried out, the system's analyst will **start the whole process again** from the beginning:

- The new system will be **re-analysed** to see if it **still meets** the company's requirements
- Updated **requirements specifications** will be devised
- **New designs** will be produced with **improvements** to the system
- These **improvements** will be **developed** into the system
- Improvements to the system will be **tested, installed** and then **evaluated**.



System errors will be fixed and hardware/software

Activity![The Evaluation Stage - Research Sheet](#)

Click the above task and answer the questions about the Evaluation Stage.

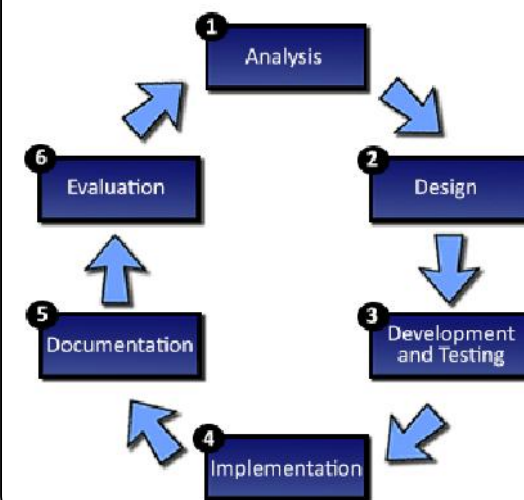
upgrades will be carried out.



Extra functionality can be added to the system.

NOTE:

The '**System's Life Cycle**' is given this name because the process repeats **again** and **again** in a **continuous cycle**.



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**Next - The Systems Life Cycle
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[Back to top](#)